

THEATRE REVIEW

Heart of Darkness

Director: Mahesh Dattani

Starring: Seema Azmi

Controversial Urdu poet Sara Shagufta's life was underscored by repression, tragedy, turmoil and depression. As director Mahesh Dattani charts the journey of this troubled Pakistani poet in the '70s and '80s, it has all the ingredients for a dark and deeply harrowing hour of theatre. But Dattani has succeeded in making this both entertaining and gripping without over-indulging. Actor Seema Azmi, a National School of Drama graduate, has delivered a powerful performance, using props such as a wedding sari, money and flowers to underline the conflict in her life. Not only are there sardonic moments where Sara jokes about her own misfortunes, but they come at the most pivotal times. When her husband calls her a prostitute during a child custody battle, she replies "yes," sway-



AZMI IN SARA

ing the courts in her favour by claiming the children are not his. It's this miscarriage that is the turning point in her life and fuels her passion to start writing.

Sara's poetic life started when she married her second husband, also a poet. She toiled day and night to educate herself and started writing free verse, expressing her innermost feelings on the suffocating society she lived in. Her only published work was *Aankhein*, a compilation of 40 poems. Sara has come to be seen as the subcontinent's Virginia Woolf and Sylvia Plath, who suffered a similar fate in the West.

by Nishika Patel



EXHIBITION

Body Art

Curated by art historian Yashodhara Dalmia, the exhibition titled *Volte Face: Souza's Iconoclastic Vision* is a 10-day show that will host film screenings, poetry sessions, talks with collectors such as Ebrahim Alkazi and Anjolie Ela Menon as well as workshops for chil-



SOUZA'S WORKS ON DISPLAY

dren. This is the largest exhibition of Souza's works in recent years in India, which includes both drawings and oils. Dalmia has chosen about 200 odd

works, 40 per cent of which are pen and ink and chemical drawings and many are significant in their own right. The works of human form and specifically heads are the strength of the exhibition. On till April 20. At Lalit Kala Akademi, Delhi.

by S. Sahaya Ranjit



FILM REVIEW

TUM MILO TO SAHI

Fatally Bland

RATING ★☆☆☆☆

Director: Kabir Sadanand

Starring: Dimple Kapadia, Nana Patekar

The ageing beauty meets the ageing angry man and it's hate at first sight. They quarrel over a bottle in a supermarket, then over a child's cycle, finally over a cup of coffee. They come together, he the sour south Indian clerk who could have been an ace lawyer, and she the daffy Parsi coffee shop owner, to fight the big bad MNC that is trying to destroy the city's individuality. Unfortunately, they have to share space with a pair of uninspiring youngsters who chatter charmlessly and a couple who are meant to embody the typical urban EM-inspired middle-class angst. Mohnish Behl's meanie lawyer is the only one who gets to be gleefully evil while Nana Patekar and Dimple get no chance to get it on.

by KB